

Finding a room as a student in the Netherlands

A database that shows who can actually find housing, and who is left with nothing

Natalia Jarmakowska Kolja Nitschke
Hanna Serafin Andrei Hoptiar

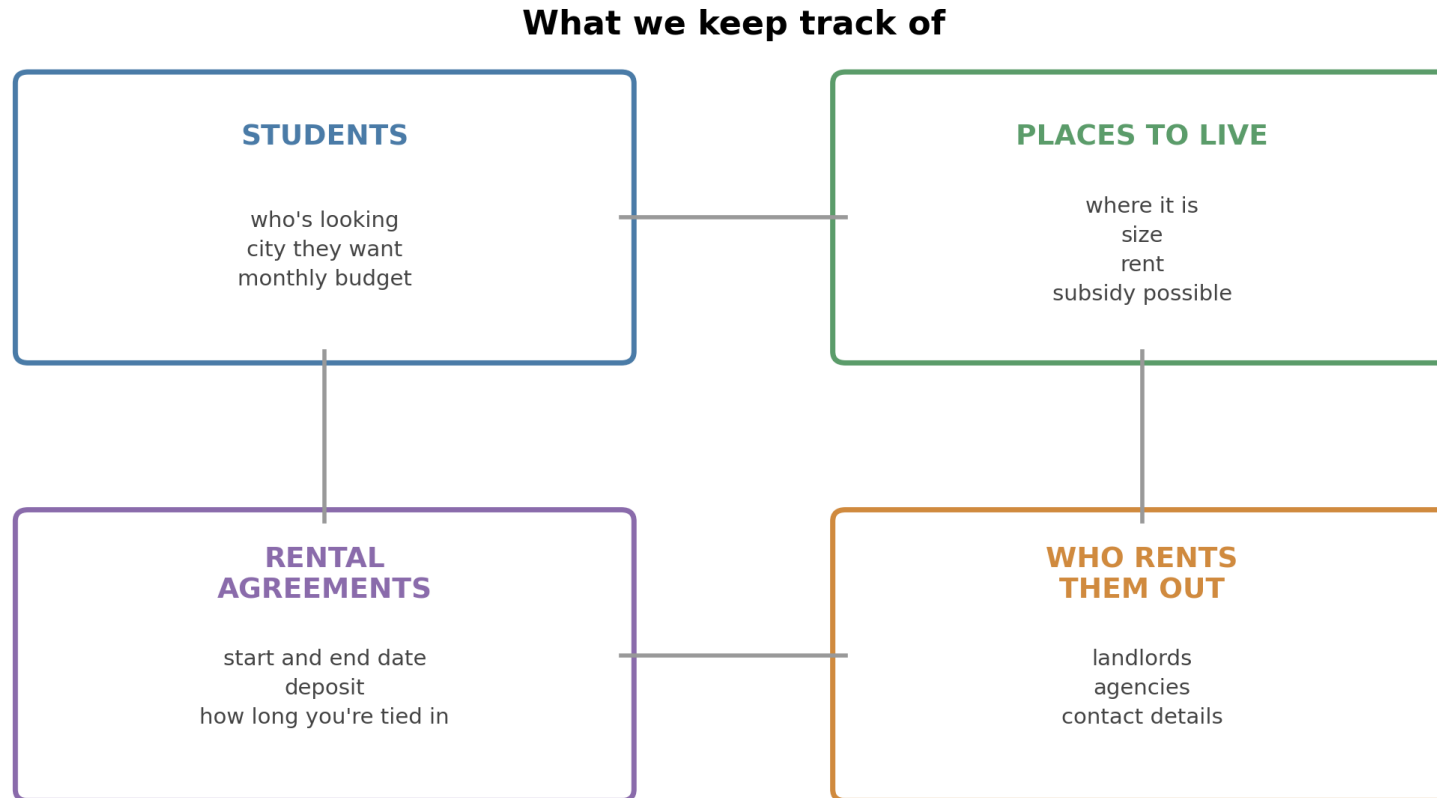
24.09.2026

You get into university here. Then you find out you also need a room.

- The places that fit a student budget are gone before you arrive in the country
- What is left costs more per month than a grant or a part time job covers
- Deposits of three or four months, from landlords nobody is checking

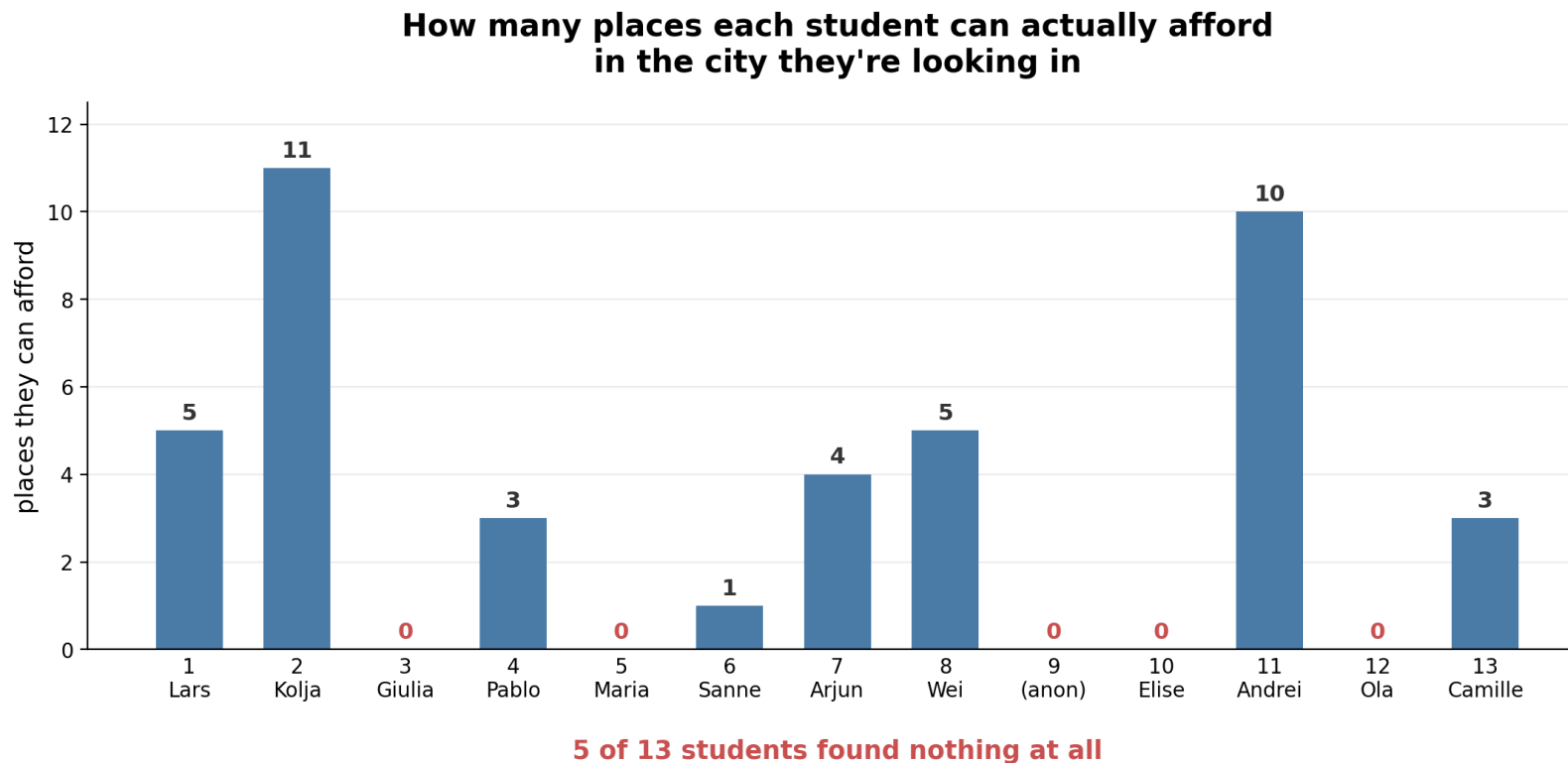
So we built a database to look at it properly instead of guessing.

What we keep track of



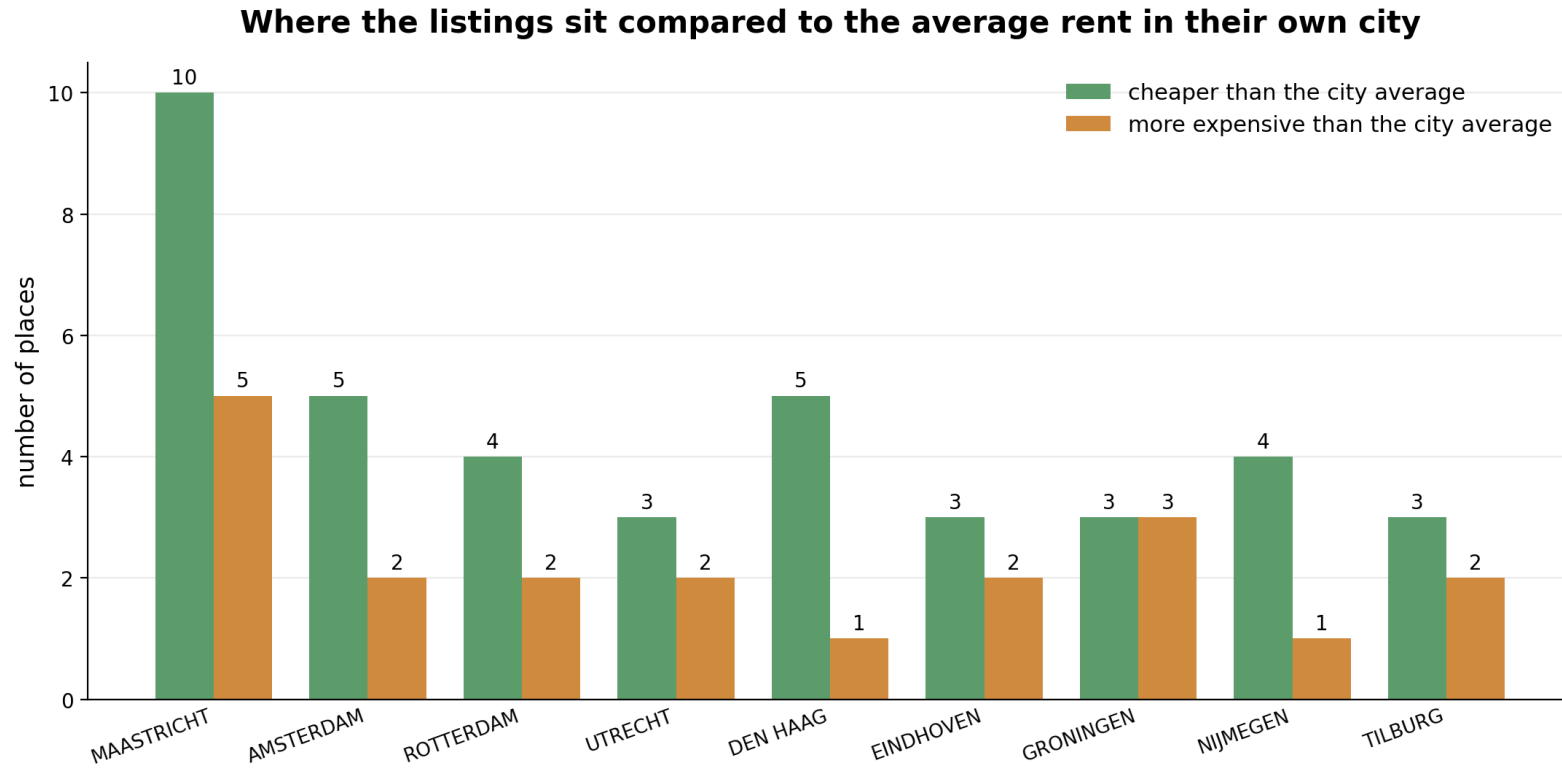
everything is connected, so one question can reach across all four

Can our students afford anything at all?



Five of thirteen gave us a city and a budget, and there was nothing for them.

How listings sit against their own city



Cheap for the city still is not cheap for a student.

Landlords with nobody in the middle

LANDLORD	PROPERTIES
Mohammed El Amrani	5
Lisa Mulder	5

10

properties rented out with no agency involved. If the contract goes wrong, it is just you and them.

We can also list every student still without housing.

Who still has nowhere to live

STUDENT	LOOKING IN	CAN PAY PER MONTH
andrei.pop	Maastricht	€700
ola.nowak	Amsterdam	€550
camille.blanc	Utrecht	€900

A university could run this in August and know exactly who to call.

What our database cannot do yet

Our data is made up. It is built to look realistic, but it is not real listings, so it shows the shape of the problem and not the scale of it.

- No availability dates, so we cannot say whether a place is free in September
- No distance to campus, one of the first things anyone actually checks
- No reviews or reports, so a landlord who scams people looks like any other
- **No type on the listings.** We store what students want, studio or room or apartment, but never what each place is. So preferences currently do nothing.

We found that last one ourselves while testing the matching.

What we decided to assume

- **One person per agreement.** No shared flats, no housemates splitting the rent.
- **One city per student.** In reality people search three or four at once.
- **Rent covers everything.** Monthly, with no separate bills for gas, water or internet.
- **A deposit over two months is worth flagging.** That is the Dutch norm, not a legal judgement from us.

Each one makes the picture simpler than reality, and each one is fixable.

Where this goes next

In the next two weeks

- Record what type each place is, so preferences finally do something
- Flag contracts asking for more deposit than the norm
- Turn more of our answers into charts instead of tables

If it carried on after this course

- Real listings coming in automatically instead of data we wrote
- Distance to each university
- A way for students to report a landlord

Then it stops being a class project and becomes something you would send to a first year in August.